

SINGAPORE

TOKENISED REAL WORLD ASSETS BUILDER WORKSHOP



CK Ong · Acting Chief Executive Officer · Arbitrum Open House · 22 September 2026

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About the Speaker

CK Ong is the Acting Chief Executive Officer of SBI Digital Markets, the Singapore-based digital asset and tokenisation arm of Japan's SBI Group, one of Asia's largest financial conglomerates. Operating under an MAS license, he leads strategy, business and execution for the firm's real-world asset (RWA) tokenisation practice.

Under CK's leadership, SBI Digital Markets has closed some of Asia's most significant RWA transactions, including Asia's largest content IP RWA deal, a cross-border fine wine tokenisation across two countries, and the distribution of two leading tokenised money market funds.

Previously a founding member of UOB's blockchain and digital assets team, CK engages actively with regulators across APAC — including Singapore MAS, Malaysia SC, Thailand SEC and Indonesia OJK — on tokenization frameworks. He brings close to two decades of banking experience, including senior roles at UOB and Standard Chartered across Singapore, South Korea and China.

The SBI Group Solid Track Record

*A listed Japanese conglomerate,
regulated by the FSA*

#1

In number of
securities accounts
in Japan

47M

Accounts for various
financial services

#2

Largest exchange in
Japan (Japannext)

25

Countries and regions
with SBI offices

Our strong global presence



01

The Market, Honestly

Where tokenised RWA really stands



Everyone Quotes a Number Where the Market Actually Is

ON-CHAIN VALUE

\$31–38B

Tokenised RWA on public chains, excluding stablecoins

CONCENTRATION

~80%

Sits in US Treasuries and cash-equivalent products

HOLDERS

~960K

Individual RWA holders globally — still a small market

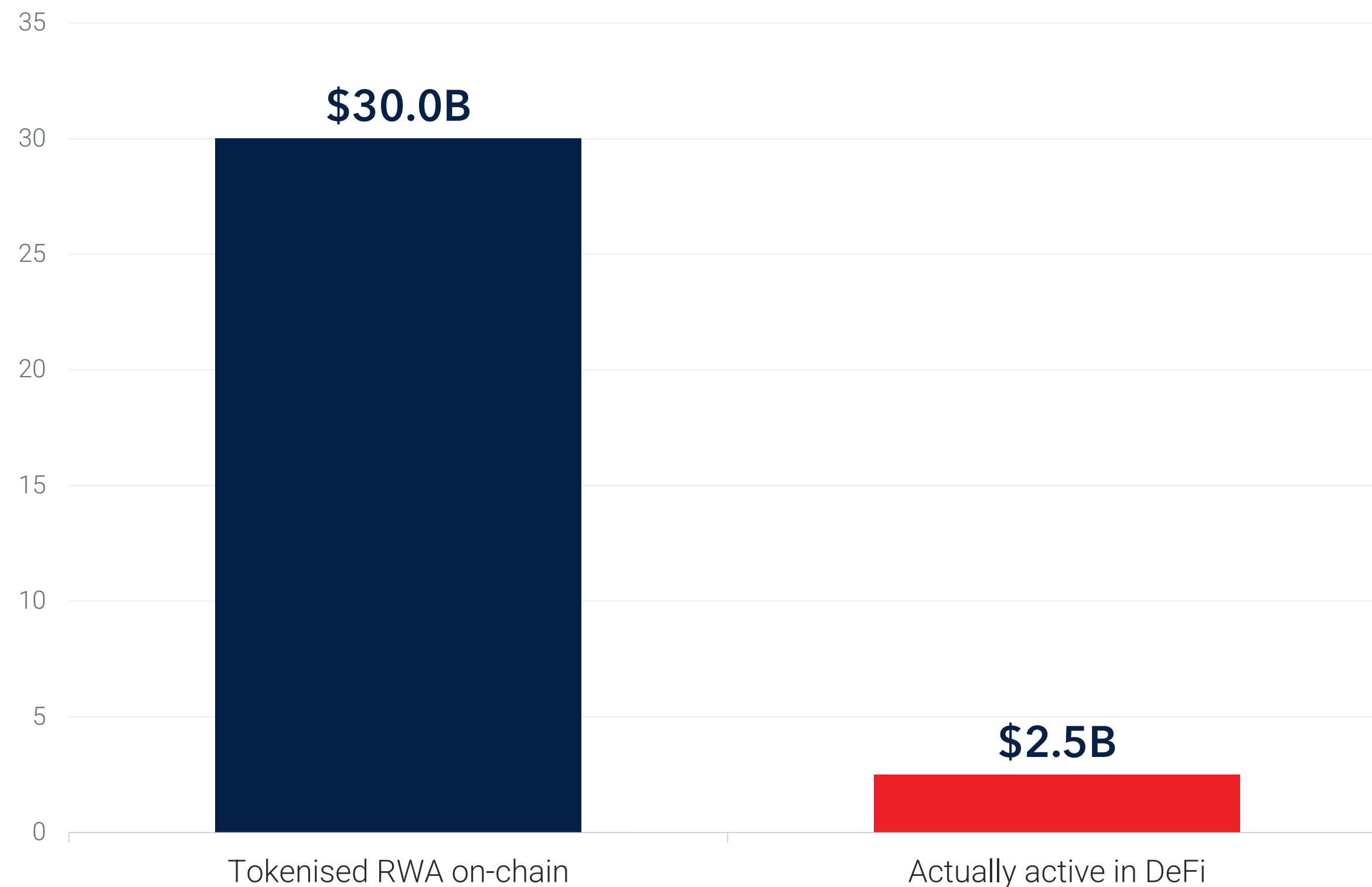
The trackers count differently.

Distributed versus represented value, platform-locked assets, whether stablecoins are in or out. Mid-2026 estimates for the same market ranged from \$23B to \$38B. If a pitch deck quotes one number to three decimal places, that tells you about the author, not the market.

Sources: rwa.xyz, DeFiLlama, Stobox State of RWA 2026 (mid-year), Cointelegraph. Figures as of Jul–Sep 2026.

Tokenised Is Not Liquid Most of It Never Moves

US\$ BILLION, MID-2026



~9%

of tokenised RWA value is actually used inside DeFi. The rest is a database entry with a wallet address.

BOND & MONEY MARKET FUNDS

\$16.6B on-chain · \$0.9B DeFi-active

Issuance quadrupled. Usability did not.

Sources: DeFiLlama via CryptoSlate (May 2026); Castle Labs; rwa.xyz. Rounded.

02

Building It Properly

Standards, trade-offs, failure modes



The Token Is the Easy Part Claim, Wrapper, Token

An RWA is a legal claim on something off-chain. The token points at that claim. If the claim is weak, the token is decoration.

01 THE CLAIM

Who owns what

Who legally owns the asset, under which law, and enforceable in which court.

02 THE WRAPPER

The vehicle

The note, bond, fund, trust or SPV that holds the asset and issues against it.

03 THE TOKEN

The representation

A smart contract representing units of the wrapper. A few hours of Solidity.

Technology cannot fix an unclear legal claim. The legal structure decides what the contract is even allowed to do.

The Credibility Stack

What a Counterparty Checks First

01 REGULATORY

Regulatory clarity

Which licence, which regime, and which regulator has said yes — in writing.

ASK YOURSELF

Can you show the approval?

02 DISTRIBUTION

Distribution

Who is legally allowed to buy this, and whether you already have a channel to them.

ASK YOURSELF

Can you name ten eligible buyers?

03 CUSTODY

Custody

Who holds the asset and the keys, and what happens to holders if they fail.

ASK YOURSELF

Who is the custodian of record?

04 COMMERCIAL

Commercial viability

Whether the economics survive compliance, servicing and custody costs.

ASK YOURSELF

What does it cost per holder, per year?

Miss one and the deal does not close. Most teams over-invest in the token and under-invest in the buyer.

Pick Your Lane Compliance vs Composability

LANE 1

Ownership-first

Permissioned rails and whitelisted wallets. Legal-title fidelity comes first.

Wins Institutions can hold it

Costs It cannot touch open DeFi

Where most of today's ~\$30B sits

LANE 2

Composability-first

Built for permissionless circulation from day one, with compliance enforced at the edges.

Wins Collateral, lending, real volume

Costs A narrower set of eligible assets

Where the growth is — Ondo, Aave Horizon, Morpho

Decide which lane before you write code. Teams that try to be both usually ship neither.

Redemption Is the Liquidity

T+0 Meets 30-180 Days

WHAT DEFI EXPECTS

T+0

Liquidation bots close a position in seconds, because a deep secondary market exists to sell into.

WHAT THE ASSET DELIVERS

30-180 days

Typical redemption windows for tokenised funds, private credit and structured products. Even “liquid” fund tokens settle T+1 to T+3.

A risk module that cannot liquidate on demand cannot set a meaningful loan-to-value ratio. That one sentence explains why most tokenised RWA sits outside DeFi.

BEING SOLVED NOW

Settlement-fronting layers close the gap: solver auctions that close a position at T+0 and absorb the redemption window for a spread, and USDC vaults that front instant exits. Aave Horizon and Morpho run RWA collateral on this basis.

How RWA Projects Die A Pre-Mortem

01

The claim is unclear

The token transfers; legal title does not. The secondary market is fiction.

02

No qualified buyer channel

KYC, accreditation and jurisdiction shrink the buyer pool before launch.

03

Whitelisting kills composability

Compliance so tight the asset can never touch a lending market.

04

Redemption confused with trading

A thin secondary market is survivable. Unclear redemption is not.

05

No market maker will quote

Fragmented venues, no listing standard, and spreads that blow out.

06

Cross-chain fragmentation

1–3% pricing gaps for identical assets; 2–5% friction to move capital.

Five of these six are commercial or legal. One is technical.

03

From Our Deal Book

Live deals and Project Guardian



Recent Milestones Transactions & Partnerships

JUN 2026

BTC Dual-Currency Note

Issued by Ericsenz Capital, distributed by SBIDM, Asia's first physically deliverable 3-month BTC DCN was launched in Dec 2025.

PARTNERS

Ericsenz Capital

MAY 2026

SettleMint Strategic MoU

Signed an MoU with SettleMint to scale issuance, servicing and settlement of tokenised bonds, funds, deposits and equities across their lifecycle.

PARTNERS

SettleMint

FEB 2026

IP-Backed Tokenised RWA

Closed 2 IP-securitisation RWA bonds to institutional standards, including a US\$30M music album deal and a performance-rights structure.

PARTNERS

Institutional investors

NOV 2025

Chainlink Partnership

Adopted Chainlink's CCIP to move compliant, interoperable tokenised real-world assets across public and private blockchains, with policy-based compliance under evaluation.

PARTNERS

Chainlink

SEP 2025

Luxury Wine Notes (TH & KR)

Structured by SBIDM and issued out of Guernsey, the notes were sold within a private placement in Switzerland, demonstrating cross-jurisdictional execution capabilities.

PARTNERS

Token X, Kyobo Life Insurance

Project Guardian

SBI Digital Asset Holdings & SBI Digital Markets

2024

Tokenised Money Market Fund with Digital Transfer Agent



SBI Digital Markets (SBIDM) and UBS Asset Management conducted a pilot, demonstrating the potential application of a UBS tokenised fund with Variable Capital Company (VCC) structure, achieving operational efficiencies with smart contract-based automation of fund subscription and redemption workflows.

SBIDM created a digital transfer agent smart contract, leveraging Chainlink's Cross-Chain Interoperability Protocol.

2023

Repurchase Agreement "Repo" with Natively Issued Digital Bonds



UBS, SBI, DBS launched the world's first live repurchase transaction (repo) with a natively-issued digital bond on a public blockchain.

The transaction automatically and instantly settled a repo, digital bond purchase and redemption using regulated digital payment tokens, across regulated entities located in three different jurisdictions (Japan, Singapore, Switzerland).

2022

Live Cross-Currency Transaction in Tokenised JPY & SGD Deposits



JP Morgan and SBI executed a first-ever live foreign exchange transaction with tokenised Japanese Yen and Singapore Dollar deposits, using a DeFi protocol on a public blockchain, between regulated financial institutions.

The live transaction demonstrate that cross currency transactions of tokenized assets can be traded, cleared and settled instantaneously among direct participants.

2022

Trading of Tokenised Government Bonds



SBI and DBS simulated trading against global liquidity pools of tokenized government bonds on a public blockchain.

Tokenised securities and cash were placed into UniSwap DeFi liquidity pools, enabling trading activities against the pools instead of bilateral counterparties.

What These Deals Have in Common Patterns for Builders

01 WRAP FIRST

The instrument came before the token

Every deal sat inside a regulated wrapper before anything was minted: the BTC dual-currency note, the IP-backed RWA bonds, the Guernsey-issued wine notes, the UBS VCC fund.

IMPLICATION

Design the legal wrapper first. The contract implements it.

02 BUYERS FIRST

Distribution was arranged before launch

Institutional investors for the IP bonds, a Swiss private placement for the wine notes, and EAM channels for structured products.

IMPLICATION

Identify eligible buyers before you mint.

03 PUBLIC CHAINS

DeFi works with regulators in the room

Project Guardian tested tokenised bonds against Uniswap pools, settled FX through a DeFi protocol, and ran a transfer agent on Chainlink CCIP.

IMPLICATION

Compliance and composability coexist when designed together.

04

For the Buildathon

Where to build and how to test it



Six Gaps You Could Ship Into Where the Opportunity Is

Compliance SDK

Deploying a 3643 or 7943 token still needs deep spec knowledge. Nobody has made it boring yet.

Redemption fronting

Absorb the 30–180 day window, return T+0, earn the spread.

NAV and pricing oracles

No continuous market means periodic NAVs and broker quotes. Ugly, unsolved, necessary.

Secondary venues and RFQ

Fragmented listings, no standard, few market makers. A credible venue is a moat.

Investor onboarding

KYC, accreditation and jurisdiction checks are still bespoke work per issuer.

Cross-chain RWA pricing

Identical assets trade 1–3% apart across chains. That gap is arbitrage or a product.

Pick the one you can demo in three weeks, not the one with the biggest TAM slide.

Before You Write Code

Five Questions That Predict a Business

- 1 Who is legally allowed to buy this — and have you spoken to ten of them?
- 2 What is the exit, redemption or secondary, and what is the stated window?
- 3 If your platform disappears tomorrow, does the holder still own the asset?
- 4 What do compliance and servicing cost per holder, per year?
- 5 Would this asset be attractive if it were not tokenised?

If the answer to the last one is no, tokenisation will not save it. It will make the failure faster and more public.

Regulatory Clarity Is a Moat Not a Tax

Licences take years

Anyone can fork your contracts this afternoon. Nobody can fork a regulatory approval. That asymmetry is the durable part of your position.

Partner with the licence

You do not need to become a regulated entity on day one. You need a working relationship with one — a faster route than most founders assume.

Build where rules are written

Singapore, the EU under MiCA and the US after 2025 all now have workable frameworks. Uncertainty is no longer the excuse it was.

Every month spent getting legal and custody right is a month a competitor cannot skip.

If You Remember Three Things

- 01** Minting takes hours. Rights, custody, compliance and distribution are the product.
- 02** Tokenisation creates the possibility of liquidity — never liquidity itself.
- 03** The ~\$30B sitting idle is not a warning. It is your customer list.

Questions welcome – and happy to keep talking after.

Mentoring and internships available through the Arbitrum Open House programme.

SINGAPORE

Thank you
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